

Lesson 11: “The Field is White Already to Harvest” (See [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us resolve to strengthen the kingdom of God through diligent service, particularly by sharing the gospel through missionary work.

Samuel Smith → Phineas Young → John P. Greene → _____ → †1. Attention Activity

Historical context of: [D&C 4, 11](#); [D&C 12, 14, 15, 16](#); [D&C 33](#)

Related Videos: [The Worth of Souls](#) (Pres. Monson, 2:36); [A Glad Message to Share](#) (Pres. Uchtdorf, 2:42);

Examples of sharing the gospel: [Member Missionary](#). Click on the arrows of each picture for more examples.

1. “Serve him with all your heart, might, mind and strength.”

- D&C 4:1-2 What does it mean to serve with all our heart, might, mind, and strength?

Why are we sometimes less than fully committed to the Lord's service?

How can we improve our submission to serve the Lord with full devotion? †2. Joseph Smith, Sr.

What experiences have you had when sharing the gospel with your family or neighbors? With people at school or work? With people you meet as you travel? In other circumstances?

2. Prepare to serve the Lord.

What are some of the attributes the Lord desires in those who serve Him? List and discuss.

- D&C 4:3; 11:8. Why is desire to serve important and how can we increase our desire to serve Christ?

- D&C 4:5-6; 12:8; 18:19. In these verses, which attributes are repeated most frequently?

†3. D&C 4:6. Attributes to Develop for the Service of God

Please share an experience that shows the importance of any of these attributes in serving the Lord.

- D&C 11:6, 20. What are some reasons obedience is important in serving the Lord?

- D&C 4:7; 31:12. How has prayer helped you in serving the Lord?

Challenge: Select one of these attributes and prayerfully strive to improve in it.

- D&C 11:21. How have your experiences shown the wisdom of this counsel?

3. “The field is white.”

- D&C 4:4; 11:3; and 33:3. How is missionary work like a field ready to be harvested?

- D&C 60:13; 75:3. “Thou shalt not idle away thy time, neither shalt thou bury thy talent that it may not be known.”

How might this warning apply to us? Why do some of us delay sharing the gospel? †4. Elder Henry B. Eyring

4. “Open your mouths and they shall be filled.”

- D&C 11:9; 33:10-11; 31:3-4; 18:10-14. “Say nothing but repentance unto this generation.”

- D&C 18:20-21. “Contend against no church ... speak the truth in soberness”; 38:41 “in mildness and in meekness”; 42:6, 14 “as with the sound of a trumpet ... if we receive not the Spirit ye shall not teach”; 100:7-8 “in the spirit of meekness ... as ye do this the Holy Ghost shall be shed forth in bearing record unto all things whatsoever ye shall say.”

Why is it important to avoid contention in teaching the gospel?

What does it mean to “[lift] up your voices as with the sound of a trumpet”?

How can we be both bold and meek as we teach the gospel? (See Alma 38:10-12)

- D&C 11:21; 14:8; 19:38. How can we overcome fear in sharing the gospel?

Why might Samuel Smith have felt like a failure after his first mission?

What can we learn from his experience to help in our missionary efforts?

5. The Lord promises great blessings to those who labor in His service.

†5. Promised Blessings

Next Week: Lesson 12: “The Gathering of My People”; See L12 [Class Member Study Guide](#). † •
(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).)

†1. **Attention Activity:** “In April 1830, Samuel Smith began traveling to neighboring towns in New York to preach the gospel and introduce people to the Book of Mormon. He had little success, though he did sell a copy of the book to a man named Phinehas Young. In June 1830, Samuel was set apart by the Prophet Joseph to take a missionary journey to the east. He walked 25 miles the first day and stopped at many houses, but the people treated him unkindly and would not listen. The next day he left a copy of the Book of Mormon with John P. Greene, a Methodist minister. John Greene’s wife, Rhoda, was Phinehas Young’s sister.

“Facing rejection from almost everyone he contacted, Samuel felt that his mission had not been very successful. However, the books he left with Phinehas Young and John P. Greene led to their conversion and the conversion of many others. For example, Phinehas Young and Rhoda Greene had a brother named Brigham, who was converted and later became the second President of the Church. Brigham Young’s friend Heber C. Kimball also joined the Church. He later served in the First Presidency. Both Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball were instrumental in the conversion of thousands in the United States and England.

“... [I]f you were to fill in the blank on the chalkboard with the names of all the people who have been influenced by Samuel Smith’s missionary work, you would have to write millions of names. Those directly influenced included some of the great leaders of the Church.

“... [W]hen we share the gospel there is potential to bless many people now and hundreds or even thousands in the future.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†2. **Joseph Smith, Sr.** “Joseph Smith, Sr., was filled with the testimony of the truth, and was always anxious to share it with others. He was almost sixty when he made the tedious journey ... to carry the gospel to his father and mother, his sisters and brothers. Soon after his return [home,] he was imprisoned for a small debt of fourteen dollars, rather than deny the divinity of the Book of Mormon and be forgiven the debt! He was cast into a cell with a condemned murderer and left for four days without food. Later he was transferred to the prison workyard where he preached the gospel and converted two persons whom he later baptized. He was in prison a full month before his family was able to obtain his release” (E. Cecil McGavin, *The Family of Joseph Smith* [1963], 68; see also Lucy Mack Smith, *History of Joseph Smith*, ed. Preston Nibley [1958], 172-73, 179-86).

†3. **D&C 4:6. Attributes to Develop for the Service of God:** “Peter, in his injunction to the Saints to take upon them the ‘divine nature’ (2 Peter 1:4-8), lists nearly the same characteristics found in Doctrine and Covenants 4:6. Peter encouraged them to give all diligence in developing these godlike characteristics. President David O. McKay applied Peter’s teachings to Latter-day Saints:

“ ‘[Peter] wrote on one occasion: ‘... that we might be partakers of the divine nature.’ (2 Peter 1:4.) He realized what it means to be in touch with the spiritual, to rise above the temporal, the sensual, and partake of the divine Spirit of God.

“ ‘... that is the purpose of making us more capable of responding to the Spirit and subduing the sensual....

“ ‘That is why we like to have every young man and every young woman utilize his or her time intelligently, usefully, to bring the soul in harmony with the spirit ... ’” (In Conference Report, Oct. 1961, p. 90.)

†4. **Elder Henry B. Eyring:** “It’s easy to say, ‘The time isn’t right.’ But there is danger in procrastination. Years ago I worked for a man in California. He hired me; he was kind to me; he seemed to regard me highly. I may have been the only Latter-day Saint he ever knew well. I don’t know all the reasons I found to wait for a better moment to talk with him about the gospel. I just remember my feeling of sorrow when I learned, after he had retired and I lived far away, that he and his wife had been killed in a late-night drive to their home in Carmel, California. He loved his wife. He loved his grandchildren, and he will love their children and will want to be with them forever.

“Now I don’t know how the crowds will be handled in the world to come. But I suppose that I will meet him, that he will look into my eyes, and that I will see in them the question, ‘Hal, you knew. Why didn’t you tell me?’” (“[A Voice of Warning](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1998, 33).

†5. **Promised Blessings:**

- a. D&C 4:4; 11:3—receiveth “salvation to his soul”
- b. D&C 18:15-16—“how great shall be your joy”
- c. D&C 31:5; 84:60-61—“your sins are forgiven”
- d. D&C 31:7; 109:55-57—“I will open the hearts”
- e. D&C 31:11; 84:85; 100:5-6—“given you by the Comforter what you shall do and whither you shall go”
- f. D&C 31:13; 75:9-13; 84:88—“I am with you”
- g. D&C 71:9-10—“no weapon ... formed against you shall prosper”
- h. D&C 84:80—“shall not be weary in mind”
- i. D&C 100:7-8—“Holy Ghost shall be shed forth in bearing record unto all things whatsoever ye shall say.”

Recommended Reading:

- 1. Elder Henry B. Eyring, “[A Voice of Warning](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1998, 33.
- 2. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 4.
- 3. President Thomas S. Monson, “[See Others as They May Become](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2012, 68.

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Further Enrichment Resources:

D&C 18:15-16. “how great shall be your joy”

Adriana Vásquez, Colombia: “One day while studying for my seminary class, [I had a beautiful and distinct impression](#). As I was reading over the lesson for the next day, I saw the face of a friend from school and had the strong feeling that I should share my testimony with her.

“[Despite the clarity of this impression, I was afraid](#). I was worried that my friend might reject me, particularly because she didn’t seem to be the kind of girl who would be interested in joining the Church.

“I thought back to a talk by Sister Mary N. Cook of the Young Women general presidency in which she challenged us to work hard and be valiant. I wanted to be like this, [so I wrote this girl a letter and testified of the truthfulness of the Church and of my love for the Book of Mormon](#). The next day I slipped a copy of the Book of Mormon, together with my letter, into her bag.

“[To my surprise, my friend was very receptive to the gospel](#). Starting that day, she would tell me about what she had learned in her study of the Book of Mormon. A few weeks later, I introduced her to the missionaries. Almost immediately, she received a confirmation from the Holy Ghost that what she was learning was true. The missionaries and I cried as she told us of her feelings. My friend was soon baptized, and [her parents were amazed to see the changes that had occurred in her](#).

“[I am so happy](#) I was able to overcome my fears and help bring the gospel into her life.” (“[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary—Youth: Sharing with a Friend](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 7)

President Dieter F. Uchtdorf: “Be a Light

“A favorite saying of mine often attributed to St. Francis of Assisi reads, ‘[Preach the gospel at all times and if necessary, use words](#).’^[1] Implicit in this saying is the understanding that often the most powerful sermons are unspoken.

“When we have integrity and live consistently by our standards, people notice. When we radiate joy and happiness, they notice even more.

“Everyone wants to be happy. When we members of the Church radiate the light of the gospel, people can see our happiness and sense the love of God filling and overflowing in our lives. They want to know why. They want to understand our secret...” (“[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 4)

President Dieter F. Uchtdorf: “Be Full of Grace

“Unfortunately, it is so easy to be disagreeable. It happens too often that we argue, belittle, and condemn. When we become angry, rude, or hurtful with people, the last thing they want is to learn more about us. It is impossible to know how many people have either left the Church or never joined because someone said something that hurt or offended them.

“There is so much incivility in the world today... The scriptures teach, “Let your speech be always[s] with grace, seasoned with salt, that ye may know how ye ought to answer every man” ([Colossians 4:6](#)).

“I like the idea of [our words being clear as a sunny sky and full of grace](#). Can you imagine what our families, wards, nations, and even the world would be like if we could adopt this simple principle?” (“[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 4)

President Dieter F. Uchtdorf: “Be Filled with Faith

“Sometimes we take upon ourselves too much credit or too much blame when it comes to others accepting the gospel. It’s important to remember that the Lord doesn’t expect us to do the converting.

“[Conversion comes not through our words but through the heavenly ministrations of the Holy Spirit](#). Sometimes all it takes is [one single phrase](#) of our testimony or about an experience to set in motion the softening of a heart or the opening of a door that can lead others to experience sublime truths through the promptings of the Spirit...

“Brothers and sisters, [have faith... God doesn’t ask you to convert but rather to open your mouths...](#)” (“[A Word for the Hesitant Missionary](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2013, 4)

President Thomas S. Monson: “Back in the year 1961, a worldwide conference was held for mission presidents, and every mission president in the Church was brought to Salt Lake City for those meetings. I came to Salt Lake City from my mission in Toronto, Canada.

“In one particular meeting, [N. Eldon Tanner](#) ... had just returned from his initial experience of presiding over the missions in Great Britain and western Europe. [He told of a missionary who had been the most successful missionary whom he had met in all of the interviews he had conducted...](#)

“[Brother Tanner asked him](#) what was different about his approach—[why he had such phenomenal success when others didn’t...](#) He said that if he knocked on the door and saw a man smoking a cigar and dressed in old clothes and seemingly uninterested in anything—particularly religion ... [In his mind he would look at him as clean-shaven and wearing a white shirt and white trousers](#). And the missionary could see himself leading that man into the waters of baptism. He said, ‘When I look at someone that way, I have the capacity to bear my testimony to him in a way that can touch his heart.’

“[We have the responsibility to look at our friends, our associates, our neighbors this way](#). Again, we have the responsibility to see individuals not as they are but rather as they can become. I would plead with you to think of them this way.” (“[See Others as They May Become](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2012, 68)